012. Yusuf ~ Joseph

111 Ayaat (Makki)

FOCUS

THE STORY OF PROPHET YUSUF
TRUST IN DIVINITY
ALLAH IS LATEEF (SUBTLE)

DID YOU KNOW?

YUSUF WAS THE SON OF YAQUB BIN IS-HAAC BIN IBRAHEEM. PROPHET YAQUB IS ALSO KNOWN AS ISRAAIL AND HE HAD 12 SONS.
THE REVELATION OF THIS SURA ON THE NIGHT OF HIJRA SHOWS THE SIMILARITY IN THE CONSPIRACY OF FAMILY MEMBERS - JUST AS PROPHET YUSUF WAS SUBJECTED TO CONSPIRACY BY HIS BROTHERS, SO WAS THE PROPHET SUBJECTED TO THE SAME BY HIS UNCLES...
SIMILARLY, JUST AS THE BROTHERS OF PROPHET YUSUF HAD NO CHOICE BUT TO SUBMIT TO HIS AUTHORITY, SO DID THE PROPHET'S UNCLES HAVE TO SUBMIT DURING THE CONQUEST OF MAKKA. IT IS REPORTED THAT WHEN HE ENTERED MAKKA HE ADDRESSED THE MAKKANS SAYING -
"WHAT TREATMENT DO YOU EXPECT FROM ME TOWARDS YOU? THEY REPLIED - NOTHING BUT GOOD. HE REPLIED - "I SAY NOTHING EXCEPT WHAT YUSUF TOLD HIS BROTHERS..."
"HE SAID: (THERE SHALL BE) NO REPROOF AGAINST YOU THIS DAY; ALLAH MAY FORGIVE YOU, AND HE IS THE MOST MERCIFUL OF THE MERCIFUL" VERSE 92

SELECTED AYAAT

12.4	Prophet Yusuf (pbuh)
12.86	Complain only to Allah
12:100	Allah is 'Lateef'

NARRATIVE

THE MOST BEAUTFUL STORY OF THE QUR'AN BEGINS WITH A DREAM THAT YUSUF AS A CHILD NARRATES TO HIS FATHER YAQUB OF 11 STARS, THE SUN AND THE MOON PROSTRATING. HIS FATHER TELLS HIM NOT TO TELL IT TO HIS BROTHERS WHO ARE EXTREMELY JEALOUS OF HIM. THE ELDER BROTHERS PLOT TO GET RID OF HIM AND PUT HIM IN A WELL. HE IS RESCUED BY A CARAVAN AND SOLD AS A SLAVE TO AN EGYPTIAN HIGH-RANKING MINISTER. A SCANDAL ENSUES WHEN THE MINISTERS WIFE MAKES ADVANCES AND ACCUSES YUSUF OF WRONGDOING. HE IS IMPRISONED AND LATER EXHONERATED. THE KING APPOINTS HIM IN CHARGE OF THE TREASURY WHEN HE INTERPRETS HIS DREAM OF A LONG FAMINE AND RECOGNISES HIS AWESOMENESS.
THE CHAPTER CONTINUES WITH THE RETURN OF HIS BROTHERS DURING THE FAMINE AND THE EVENTUAL REUNITING OF THE FAMILY OF YAQUB REALISING THE CHILDHOOD DREAM OF YUSUF.
IT ENDS WITH AN ASSERTION OF THE LESSONS IN THE STORIES OF THE QUR'AN.